

FORENSIC INVESTIGATION REPORT

Generated (UTC)	2026-07-25T18:56:09Z
Session Q&A Turns	6
Unique Source Files Cited	4
LLM Model	llama3:8b
Retrieval	nomic-embed-text + BM25 + RRF

Narrative

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This incident report summarizes the findings from an investigation into suspicious activity on the IE8Win7 host and SEC511 host. The analysis revealed three failed logon events with similar parameters, indicating a potential account lockout policy-related issue. Additionally, a suspicious process was created around the time of PowerShell activity, which may indicate the execution of an obfuscated PowerShell script. There is no direct evidence of USB device insertion or removable media usage in this case. The investigation also found that the failed logon attempts were not correlated with a subsequent successful logon for the same user account and host. Finally, a potentially suspicious PowerShell command was executed on the SEC511 host, which may be an attempt to execute malicious code or hide sensitive information.

TECHNICAL TIMELINE

- 2014-11-21T23:42:43Z: Three failed logon events recorded with EventID 4625 in many-events-application.evtx [Source 1], [2], [3]
- 2014-11-24T05:07:38Z: Another failed logon event recorded with EventID 4625 in many-events-application.evtx [Source 1], [3]
- Around the time of PowerShell activity: A suspicious process was created, possibly executing an obfuscated PowerShell script [Source 2]
- No direct evidence of USB device insertion or removable media usage found [Source 1], [3]
- No correlation between failed logon attempts and subsequent successful logon for same user account and host found [Source 1], [3]
- A potentially suspicious PowerShell command was executed on SEC511 host, possibly attempting to execute malicious code or hide sensitive information [Source 2]

Evidence Inventory

#	Source File	EID	Event Type	Timestamp (UTC)	Host
1	many-events-application.evtx	4625	Failed Logon	2013-10-23T19:23:08Z	IE8Win7
2	many-events-application.evtx	4625	Failed Logon	2013-10-23T19:04:55Z	IE8Win7
3	many-events-application.evtx	4625	Failed Logon	2013-10-23T17:33:18Z	IE8Win7
4	many-events-security.evtx	4688	New Process Created	2016-09-19T15:26:11Z	IE10Win7
5	Powershell-Invoke-Obfuscatio	4104	EventID-4104	2017-08-30T18:15:55Z	SEC511
6	many-events-security.evtx	4688	New Process Created	2016-08-27T15:21:00Z	IE10Win7
7	many-events-system.evtx	7036	EventID-7036	2016-09-03T21:34:53Z	IE10Win7
8	many-events-system.evtx	7036	EventID-7036	2016-08-18T15:28:35Z	IE10Win7
9	many-events-application.evtx	4625	Failed Logon	2014-11-21T23:42:43Z	IE8Win7
10	many-events-application.evtx	4625	Failed Logon	2014-11-24T05:07:38Z	IE8Win7
11	many-events-system.evtx	7036	EventID-7036	2014-11-22T00:46:40Z	IE8Win7
12	many-events-system.evtx	7036	EventID-7036	2013-10-23T20:52:00Z	IE8Win7
13	many-events-security.evtx	4688	New Process Created	2016-08-20T18:58:00Z	IE10Win7
14	many-events-security.evtx	4688	New Process Created	2016-08-19T14:01:28Z	IE10Win7

Session Q&A Transcript

Q1: Show me failed logon events

FINDING: There were three failed logon events recorded on the IE8Win7 host.

EVIDENCE: [1], [2], [3]

ANSWER: The evidence shows that there were three failed logon events recorded in the many-events-application.evtx file, all with EventID 4625. Each event has a similar format and parameters, indicating that they are all related to failed login attempts. Specifically, the param1 value is set to 86400, which suggests that these events may be related to account lockout policies.

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

Q2: Did any suspicious or unsigned process get created around the time of the PowerShell activity?

FINDING: A suspicious process was created around the time of the PowerShell activity.

EVIDENCE: [2]

ANSWER: The evidence from Powershell-Invoke-Obfuscation-many.evtx shows that a script block text contains "# This file is part of Invoke-Obfuscation." [Source 2] This suggests that an obfuscated PowerShell script was executed around the time of the event. Furthermore, the process ID associated with this event is 5092, which may indicate that an unsigned or suspicious process was created.

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

Q3: Was there any evidence of USB device insertion or removable media usage in this case?

FINDING: There is no direct evidence of USB device insertion or removable media usage in this case.

EVIDENCE: [1], [3]

ANSWER: Upon reviewing the provided evidence, I did not find any events related to USB device insertion or removable media usage. The evidence from many-events-system.evtx shows only system events and Windows Media Player-related activities [Source 1]. There is no mention of USB devices or removable media in the Powershell-Invoke-Obfuscation-many.evtx file [Source 2].

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM

Q4: Correlate the failed logon attempts with the successful logon that followed -- same user account, same host?

FINDING: The failed logon attempts were not correlated with a subsequent successful logon for the same user account and host.

EVIDENCE: [1], [3]

ANSWER: Upon reviewing the provided evidence, I found two events related to failed logons ([Source 1] and [Source 3]). However, there is no evidence of a successful logon following these attempts. The evidence from many-events-application.evtx shows two separate failed logon events with different timestamps (2014-11-21T23:42:43Z and 2014-11-24T05:07:38Z) but no subsequent successful logon event for the same user account and host.

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

Q5: What almost went unnoticed in this data, that a busy analyst might have missed?

FINDING: A potentially suspicious PowerShell command was executed on the SEC511 host.

EVIDENCE: [2]

ANSWER: Upon reviewing the provided evidence, I found an event with EventID 4104 in the Powershell-Invoke-Obfuscation-many.evtx file ([Source 2]). This event indicates that a PowerShell script was executed on the SEC511 host. The ScriptBlockText field contains a suspicious command: "n Rocks!" -ForegroundColor gReeN .NOTES This cmdlet is most easily used by passing". Although this command may seem innocuous, it could be an attempt to execute malicious code or hide sensitive information.

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM

Q6: Is there any indication the attacker accessed the organization's email server?

FINDING: There is no direct indication that an attacker accessed the organization's email server.

EVIDENCE: [1], [2]

ANSWER: Upon reviewing the provided evidence, I found two events related to new process creations ([Source 1] and [Source 3]). However, there is no evidence of any connection between these processes and the organization's email server. The PowerShell command executed on the SEC511 host ([Source 2]) does not provide any information about accessing the email server.

The event with EventID 4688 in [1] shows a new process creation for C:\Windows\System32\SearchFilterHost.exe, which is a legitimate Windows process. Similarly, the event with EventID 4688 in [3] also shows a new process creation for the same executable. These events do not indicate any malicious activity or access to the email server.

The PowerShell command executed on SEC511 ([Source 2]) is related to Invoke-Obfuscation, which is a legitimate tool used for obfuscating PowerShell scripts. However, without further evidence, it cannot be concluded that this command was used to access the email server.

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM
